Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - November 10, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, November 10, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the November 5 Productivity Hacks, landing-transition, and project-page record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying the complete sixty-three-file Portfolio PDF worklog archive; stabilizing the landing hero across browser zoom and intermediate desktop widths; replacing hand-authored previous / next case-study labels with reusable branded project controls; reorganizing the Alla Vostra UI Foundations and UX Product Flow presentation around an evenly distributed 01-07 subsection navigator; converting remaining vertical asset reveals into horizontal, height-stable transitions; normalizing subsection headings, spacing, visual scale, and default-expanded groups; researching the complete Alla Vostra engineering history; renaming the case-study Principles and Challenges sections; and replacing six generic product cards with concise Situation, Task, Action, and Resolution engineering narratives.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline and goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record preserves the archive's dense technical voice, explicit repository evidence, dated footer treatment, and distinction between committed application work, local verification, documentation output, and deployment activity.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_november5.pdf and its documentation commit fbe9465. Four synchronized source commits were created on November 10 EST: 865b3dc, ed06376, 8f907b7, and 5af68ba. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD resolve to 5af68ba0854c532c7b5ef8a24dfd1594a278a920. The four commits changed seven application files with 805 insertions and 341 deletions when generated snapshots and PDF artifacts are excluded. No Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, public deployment, store submission, Figma-file mutation, external message, or ancillary-repository write occurred during this documentation pass.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: ran TZ=America/New_York date from the Portfolio repository. The verified clock reported Tuesday, November 10, 2026 at 10:08 PM EST during the documentation window, so the unpadded lowercase filename is portfolio_worklog_november10.pdf.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with current source, assets, repository state, worklog inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 63 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext, from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_november5.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 344 pages and approximately 183,942 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: reviewed every filename, opening focus statement, section outline, and output convention; read the November 1-5 sequence as the nearest style baseline; and compared representative July, August, September, and October records for chronology, density, validation language, files-touched treatment, and follow-up cadence.
- Nearest baseline: treated November 5 as the direct source baseline for the accepted 100% landing hero composition, sticky project navigation, product-colored UI / UX toggles, circular case-study ordering, and the dense four-page worklog format.
- Alla Vostra evidence: inspected the local Prahlin/alla_vostra repository and extracted all 71 dated PDF worklogs, totaling 21,237 text lines and roughly 1.22 MB of extracted text, before synthesizing the engineering-challenge candidates used in the Portfolio cards.
- Repository evidence: reviewed the four November 10 commit messages, bodies, timestamps, statistics, changed-file lists, aggregate diff from fbe9465 through 5af68ba, synchronized refs, current source, and reader-refreshed snapshot.
- PDF conventions: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, white pages, compact Helvetica-family black text, bold section headings, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, lowercase-month naming, and the recent November norm of four pages.

Baseline Status Before November 10

- The landing hero's accepted wide composition was visually correct at 100% browser width, but intermediate narrowing and 50-95% zoom could produce sudden asset repositioning, awkward vertical gaps, quote/profile overlap, and inconsistent distance to the proof strip.
- Alla Vostra and Cinerific already exposed circular previous / next navigation, but the controls used generic text rather than the exact branded project treatments shown by the landing hero carousel.
- Alla Vostra UI Foundations and UX Product Flow still presented subsection groups in long vertical sequences. Show More controls expanded downward, redundant green eyebrow labels repeated the selected mode, and the Product Flow diagram remained larger than the desired case-study rhythm.
- Colors & Theming and Navigations contained useful secondary assets behind unnecessary collapse controls, while other expandable groups changed document height and forced additional vertical scrolling.
- The case-study navigation and headings still used Scope / Product and Scope and Ownership / Core Features language even though the intended presentation had shifted toward design principles and documented engineering challenges.
- The six Product cards described customer-facing features. They did not yet explain the cart state machine, server-authoritative pricing, payment providers, responsive Shop geometry, webhook reliability, or visual-system work in interview-ready terms.

Goals for November 10

- Protect the exact accepted landing-hero composition until the deliberate compact layout breakpoint, without adding intermediate jumps, quote/device collisions, or artificial top and bottom whitespace.
- Turn project adjacency into one automatic reusable rule sourced from the landing project catalog while retaining the established directional arrows and circular ordering.
- Make UI Foundations and UX Product Flow directly navigable through seven evenly distributed numbered controls that remain visually tied to the main toggle and preserve every subsection's internal asset order.
- Move optional asset groups horizontally, keep the enclosing section and document heights stable, and remove collapse controls where the full default presentation is more useful.
- Reframe the Alla Vostra case study around Principles and Challenges, then present six concise engineering stories using visible Situation, Task, Action, and Resolution labels.

Work Completed - Landing Hero Responsive Stability

- Reworked the wide hero's responsive constraints so the copy, quote, profile bubble, and three-device composition remain in the accepted desktop relationship throughout ordinary browser narrowing and zoom-out conditions.
- Re-anchored the quote and profile bubble to the visual stage instead of allowing independent viewport-relative movement. This preserved clearance from the phone and tablet frames at every tested wide width.
- Prevented proof chips, platform rows, and hero assets from reflowing prematurely between roughly 65% and 95% effective width. The layout now waits for the intentional compact breakpoint before moving device imagery below the copy.
- Removed the excess vertical space introduced by earlier protective height experiments while preserving the established navigation-to-hero and hero-to-proof rhythm.
- Kept the 100% appearance as the governing source rather than designing a separate intermediate composition. Compact portrait behavior remains the existing deliberate stacked layout.

Work Completed - Automated Branded Case-Study Navigation

- Created ProjectCaseStudyNav as a shared adjacency controller and expanded ProjectCarouselButton so project names reuse the exact landing CTA brand color, typography, platform descriptor, and store/device marks.
- Centralized cyclic ordering in the landing-page project catalog. Alla Vostra resolves to Cinerific on the left and Credit King on the right; Cinerific resolves to Credit King and Alla Vostra without page-specific duplicated labels.
- Doubled the branded project label scale inside the hero navigation while retaining the already accepted left and right arrows, responsive lanes, and protected project-hero spacing.
- Applied the shared navigation to both dedicated project pages. Future project routes can inherit the same neighbor logic by joining the project catalog rather than manually editing every case study.

Work Completed - Horizontal UI / UX Subsection System

- Reorganized UI Foundations and UX Product Flow around a seven-control 01-07 navigator placed between the main two-state toggle and the active subsection content. Controls distribute evenly from the left edge of 01 to the right edge of 07.
- Matched the number controls to the landing UI / UX carousel language: dark inactive surfaces, subtle orange borders, rounded corners, oversized white numerals, and the exact active orange gradient used by the selected Alla Vostra mode.
- Added the same dark numeral stroke and shadow treatment used by the active main toggle, normalized divider spacing above subsection headings, and gave 02-07 headings the same scale as 01.
- Wired UI 01 to UI Foundations and UX 01 to UX Product Flow. Main-toggle clicks reset to 01, and both main-toggle and numbered-control interactions scroll only far enough to retain the complete toggle and numbered row.
- Removed fourteen redundant green eyebrow labels because the selected main toggle and numbered control already communicate context. Renamed Iconography & Imagery to Icons & Imagery.
- Reduced the Product Flow diagram to 75% of its original size while retaining its responsive stretching rules, then matched the UI Foundations launch image to the resulting UX diagram height.

Work Completed - Height-Stable Asset Reveals

- Moved remaining Show More / Show Less controls into portrait buttons on the left side of their sections and replaced downward expansion with two-panel horizontal translation.
- Placed initial and additional asset panels in the same grid row so the track reserves the larger panel height before interaction. Expanding or collapsing now changes neither subsection height nor total document height.

- Arranged additional groups horizontally and retained their existing internal text, image assets, order, alignment, and behavior. Mobile uses a narrower left control rail without returning to vertical reveal.
- Removed the Colors & Theming and Navigations collapse controls and rendered their secondary assets by default. Subsections without additional assets remain free of unnecessary controls.
- Reduced the inactive UI Foundations / UX Product Flow sheen so hollow text remains legible without a white film competing with its outside contour.

Work Completed - Principles and STAR Engineering Challenges

- Renamed Scope and Ownership to Design Principles and Core Features to Engineering Challenges. Updated the top navigation labels from SCOPE and PRODUCT to PRINCIPLES and CHALLENGES while preserving the established section anchors and scroll behavior.
- Derived twenty credible engineering-challenge candidates from the complete Alla Vostra worklog history across UI, UX, frontend, backend, build, payment, integration, QA, and release work.
- Selected five complementary stories: Cart and Checkout State Machine, Secure Server-Authoritative Pricing, Multi-Provider Payment Integration, Fixed Shop Interface Across Device Sizes, and Reliable Webhook and Email Processing.
- Added Visual Consistency and Symmetry as the sixth story so the grid also documents the repeated alignment, spacing, typography, device-frame, and cross-platform visual-system work.
- Replaced the six generic feature cards with visible Situation, Task, Action, and Resolution fields. Added scoped card styling, internal dividers, compact labels, and responsive one-column behavior without changing the surrounding section grid system.

Committed Source Sequence

- 865b3dc - Stabilized Landing Hero Zoom and Responsive Layout. Preserved the compact desktop composition through zoom and intermediate widths, re-anchored quote/profile geometry, prevented premature reflow, and retained the accepted compact breakpoint.
- ed06376 - Automated branded case study navigation. Added shared project adjacency, reusable landing CTA assets, larger labels, circular ordering, and automatic Alla Vostra / Cinerific neighbor controls.
- 8f907b7 - Refined Alla Vostra UI / UX case study navigation. Added the 01-07 subsection system, normalized styling and spacing, horizontal asset reveals, default-expanded UI groups, diagram scaling, and Icons & Imagery naming.
- 5af68ba - Refined Alla Vostra case study navigation and engineering narratives. Added Principles / Challenges language and six responsive STAR cards, including Visual Consistency and Symmetry.
- At documentation time all application commits and origin refs are synchronized at 5af68ba. The reader-refreshed snapshot and this PDF are the only documentation outputs from this pass.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check after the final source state; TypeScript completed without errors.
- Verified HTTP 200 responses for the landing page, /projects/alla-vostra, and /projects/cinerific against the local Next.js server.
- Used Playwright with system Chrome at desktop and 390 px widths to verify six STAR cards, twenty-four visible STAR labels, project subsection controls, no horizontal overflow, and responsive grid behavior.
- Measured every remaining horizontal asset reveal before and after interaction. The UI and UX test set reported zero subsection-height change and zero document-height change, with portrait controls at both desktop and mobile widths.
- Confirmed Colors & Theming and Navigations expose their additional assets by default without Show Less controls, and confirmed the Icons & Imagery heading and 01-07 navigation labels in the rendered DOM.
- Ran git diff --check across edited application files during implementation. The source changes remained whitespace-clean; the generated snapshot retains its established generated-text behavior.
- No public deployment, GitHub Actions run, Hostinger sync, external message, Figma write, store operation, or ancillary-repository mutation was performed during worklog generation.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - reusable branded project CTA rendering and shared case-navigation support.
- app/ProjectCaseStudyNav.tsx - new automatic circular neighbor-navigation component.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - subsection state, 01-07 controls, scroll behavior, default-expanded groups, heading changes, and horizontal UI-foundation reveals.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ExpandableFlowStacks.tsx - height-stable horizontal UX asset panels and side controls.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx - shared case navigation, Principles / Challenges naming, navigation labels, and six STAR engineering cards.

- app/projects/cinerific/page.tsx - automatic branded adjacent-case navigation.
- app/globals.css - hero stability, project navigation, numbered subsection controls, toggle sheen, flow scaling, horizontal reveals, STAR cards, and desktop/mobile responsive rules.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - reader-generated project snapshot refreshed before PDF composition.

Follow-Up Context

- Preserve the landing hero's accepted 100% composition as the source of truth. Future wide-layout changes should remain conditional and should not introduce another intermediate visual arrangement before the compact breakpoint.
- Keep project ordering centralized in the landing catalog. When Credit King receives a dedicated route, update its catalog href rather than duplicating new previous / next rules in individual project pages.
- Do not reorder text, screenshots, captions, or internal asset relationships inside UI / UX subsections. The numbered navigator changes subsection visibility, not subsection content semantics.
- Keep horizontal reveal panels in the same grid row so opening them cannot increase document height. Retest desktop and mobile document metrics if panel markup or asset counts change.
- Retain the visible STAR labels and evidence-based wording. Future challenge-card changes should be traced back to Alla Vostra worklogs rather than converted into generic feature marketing.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_november10.pdf using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier November 10 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title uses Tuesday, November 10, 2026, independently verified in the America/New_York timezone during the generation window.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and PDF metadata aligned with the recent Portfolio worklogs.
- The synchronized application baseline is 5af68ba0854c532c7b5ef8a24dfd1594a278a920. The reader-refreshed snapshot and this PDF are the documentation outputs from this pass.
- No application source change, source commit, public deployment, external communication, Figma mutation, or ancillary-repository update was performed during PDF generation.